



Redmi 11 Prime launch tipped

Redmi 11 Prime's India launch could reportedly happen in early September.
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Redmi K50i 5G

Performance without panache

The Redmi K50i marks the return of the Redmi K-series India three years after the Redmi K20 series, which turned out to be quite the bestseller for Xiaomi. Redmi is here to stake its claim back in the sub-₹30,000 price segment with the Redmi K50i and its powerful feature set. But does it have enough style and substance to follow the legacy of the Redmi K20 series? That's what we're going to find out in this review.

BUILD AND DESIGN

The Redmi K50i is being offered in three colours Stealth Black, Phantom Blue and Quick Silver. The black version has a soft-touch matte finish, while the blue and silver colours have a shimmering gradient effect which changes as the light shifts. Being a Redmi K-series phone, the K50i doesn't have any of the iconic markings of the K20 series and doesn't stand out from the crowd as the K20 series did.

DISPLAY

The Redmi K50i has an FFS LCD display where FFS stands for Fringe Field Switching. This isn't a new technology per se, but you won't find many smartphones using this LCD technology. It also offers wider viewing angles than normal LCD panels and has high response times. All said and done, it's still not up to the standards of an AMOLED screen, which is a bummer, in our opinion.

The display is decent enough to watch something on YouTube or even a movie on Netflix since it is HDR10 and Dolby Vision compliant. The refresh rate can go up to 144Hz, which is great since it allows for increased smoothness. Since it's not an AMOLED panel, it doesn't exhibit pitch black colours, and the minimum brightness is around 3 nits.



PERFORMANCE

The Redmi K50i draws all its power from the Dimensity 8100 chipset, which gives it a solid boost in day-to-day usage. This phone is fast and smooth, and when it comes to raw performance, it leaves the competition in the dust. The audio performance of the K50i is decent and nothing extraordinary, but it's great to see that the K50i doesn't do away with the 3.5mm audio jack. We ran multiple rounds of CPU throttling tests wherein the K50i constantly proved itself to be a stable performer capable of easily handling thermals.

CAMERAS

In typical Redmi fashion, the K50i produces decent sharp-looking pictures in daylight but fails to impress at night. The colours and dynamic range are on point for the most part, but when shooting at night, it's the main camera which shines the most. The pictures are vibrant from the get-go, and you can get Instagram-worthy images without much effort.

The ultra-wide camera manages to capture details in the middle of the frame, but as you move away and

towards the four corners, you'll notice the barrel distortion effect as well as purple fringing on the edges. Similarly, at night, the ultra-wide camera has a lot of noise, an influx of artefacts, and lens fringing. The macro camera produces pictures with washed-out colours, and it's mostly a hit-and-miss affair. Images from the selfie camera are workable, but you won't find many details when you go pixel-peeping.

BATTERY LIFE

The K50i has a sizable 5,080mAh battery which can easily last a day if you're someone who's regularly taking pictures, watching videos, playing games and checking your social feeds. However, if you're a casual user, you can easily get over a day's worth of use, especially with the stand-by optimisations in place. It takes around an hour to fully charge the K50i from 0-100 per cent, which will be decent enough for most users.

VERDICT

The Redmi K50i is a very capable smartphone that doesn't skimp on performance and offers an efficient battery life. While it doesn't have the marquee

features of the K20 series, wherever the K50i compromises, it more than makes up for it with raw performance and gaming chops. You won't mind its FFS LCD screen for some casual watching. If you're out in the market looking for a performance-driven phone, the K50i is one of the best phones you can get right now.

—Siddharth Chauhan



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SPECIFICATIONS

DISPLAY: 6.6-inch FFS LCD, FHD+, 144Hz refresh rate | THICKNESS: 8.9mm | WEIGHT: 200g | PLATFORM: MediaTek Dimensity 8100 | RAM: 6GB/8GB LPDDR5 | BUILT-IN STORAGE: 128GB/256GB UFS 3.1 | EXPANDABLE STORAGE: No | 3.5MM JACK: Yes | OS: MIUI 13 based on Android 12 | REAR CAMERA: 64MP + 8MP ultra-wide + 2MP macro | REAR CAMERA VIDEO: Up to 4K (30FPS) | FRONT CAMERA: 16MP | SPEAKERS: Stereo speakers | BATTERY AND CHARGING: 5,080mAh, 67W wired

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